

reason why I like open source and get involved with my massive community almost every day — over Slack, GitHub, LinkedIn and Twitter.”

“Individually we gain expertise, together we transform!”

Raina tells us that Docker, Kubernetes, the cloud and IoT are the four major areas in the open source domain that he has been involved in for the last five years. As he is a Docker captain, he is active in day-to-day interactions with other captains over Slack, coming up with better ways to improve the product for the community.

Raina says, “I have contributed in different ways to Moby-umbrella projects like Docker, LinuxKit and Docker Desktop in the past — by doing testing and contributing blog posts around the new releases. In the IoT space, I am currently working on two projects.” One is based on Pico, which is all about object detection and analytics using Docker, Raspberry Pi, Apache Kafka and AWS Rekognition Services. The other project involved building a CherryBot — a payload delivery robot.

As a community leader, Raina has explored a range of subjects. He believes in the mantra, “Individually we gain expertise, together we transform.” In 2015, he started building the Docker community by blogging. He started a personal blogging site called www.collabnix.com. The site bagged the ‘Most Read Blogging Site’ award for the first time in 2016 from Docker Inc. The same year, Raina became a Docker captain.

Raina adds, “Docker captain is a distinction that Docker awards select members of the community who are both experts in their field and are passionate about sharing their Docker knowledge with others. Captains are basically Docker ambassadors (not employees). I was invited to the Docker Distributed Summit in October 2016 for the first time where I got a chance to meet Solomon Hykes, the founder of Docker, in person.”

“The five-minute talk with Solomon was sufficient enough to excite me about growing this amazing Docker community, and that was the time when I expedited my blogging frequency from a monthly frequency to writing every week about new releases and keeping the community excited,” he adds.

Raina then went on to bag the ‘Tips of Docker Captain’s Award’ at Dockercon 2019 for active contribution towards the Docker community. He recalls that it was a rare moment in his life, receiving this award from Steve Singh, ex-CEO of Docker Inc., in front of an audience of 5,000 during Dockercon which happened in San Francisco, California, USA. “I won the ‘Docker Community Award’ early this year in 2020,” he adds, with pride.

“Listen to all the viewpoints within your community”

Raina bagged the Docker Community Leader award for growing the community to 10,000+ members. Early last year, Raina introduced his personal Collabnix Slack channel to all DevOps communities and today, it has close to 4000 members.

But the road to success has not been an easy one and there have been challenges. Raina tells us that he runs a Docker Bangalore community of around 10,200+ members. This is one of the largest Docker communities in the world.

Raina says, “Forward thinking and setting sustainable goals to keep up with the latest technological trends are two major challenges that I usually faced as a community leader over the recent past. With the advent of container technology, new tools and technologies are emerging at a faster pace. Being a community leader, I always need to spend a considerable amount of time learning new technologies, collaborating with community members and then encouraging them to talk about things at the meetups and conferences in order to grow the community.”

Raina points out that another big challenge in managing these huge communities is related to empathy. According to him, it is important for leaders to recognise how the community perceives them, as their leader. “Empathy allows one to imagine the different viewpoints of the community members as well as understand their feelings. With this perspective, a leader may be perceived as one who cares, and this will increase his or her credibility in the community.” Raina advises that leaders should listen to all viewpoints of the community members, irrespective of their skillsets, and then lead the community accordingly.

Raina’s take on what makes a good community leader is: “Empathy, forward-thinking, consistent dedication, eagerness to learn and lead, honesty and interpersonal skills are some of the important qualities that a community leader must have.”

With challenges come opportunities too. Raina says that he overcame many challenges by regularly listening to feedback from his community members. After every meetup or event, he gathers feedback and suggestions from the community and tries to act on them as soon as possible. He also keeps the community excited about the latest trends via Slack, LinkedIn and Twitter. He says that he has around 10,000+ organic followers on LinkedIn and close to 4,800+ active followers on Twitter. This makes it easier for him to gather feedback from the community.

Raina recounts some of the issues he faced while starting out in the open source domain. He says, “The speed of change, the long-term viability of companies developing OSS and the lack of ownership of the code are the primary challenges I faced when I started out in the OSS domain. To overcome these problems, I started tracking of pull requests more frequently, keeping a close watch over GitHub issues as well as new releases and features.”

As a part of the ARM Innovator Programme, Raina is now working on a robotics project called CherryBot. This is a payload-carrying robotic vehicle with